Combined Opportunities Guide — Darshan (Oct 2026)

Filtered for: 18 years old, first-year BSc IT (Mumbai/Titwala), India-based, n8n / API / AI-automation skills, wants resume value and some income. Only programs you are eligible for are in sections 1–5. Status checked 11 Oct 2026. Rows marked ⚠ rest on secondary sources, so confirm on the official page. Effort tags: BUILD = mostly online/building, TALK = events and speaking, SALES = referrals and promotion (you said you prefer low-talk work, so BUILD rows fit best).

Do these first

By 13–14 Oct	Finish the Multimodal AI Hackathon submission (Unstop 13 Oct, Devpost 14 Oct).
Now (rolling)	n8n forum Answer & Earn, then the n8n Ambassador Program. Both are BUILD-type and fit your skills best.
By 17 Oct	Signalpost agent-building challenge (solo, online, ₹1.2L pool).
By 31 Oct	Hacktoberfest stickers; Build With AI bootcamp, Mumbai 30–31 Oct ⚠.
This month	Apply to 2–3 of: Mistral, ElevenLabs, Cursor, Microsoft Student Ambassadors, SwytchCode. All online and low-talk.

1. Hackathons & contests

Name	Duration	Perks	What you do	Deadline to apply
Hacktoberfest 2026 + Global Hack Week (MLH) [BUILD]	1–31 Oct (GHW 9–15 Oct)	3 virtual stickers = mailed sticker pack; 15 = raffle for a T-shirt or Arduino Uno Q. Weekly DEV challenges with cash prizes (about $2,450 across 17 winners/week). Counts as an MLH event for the MLH Fellowship.	Sign in at hacktoberfest.com with a free MyMLH account, add a postal address, register for Global Hack Week, complete challenges, build with open-source AI. Pull requests no longer count this year.	31 Oct 2026. Rewards ship 8–12 weeks later.
Multimodal AI Hackathon 2026 (KamandPrompt, IIT Mandi) [BUILD]	Online, around 15 Oct	₹1 lakh prize pool.	You are already entered. Finish and submit.	13 Oct (Unstop) / 14 Oct (Devpost).
Signalpost: Build an Agent That Finds Company Information [BUILD]	Online, solo, starts 17 Oct	₹1.2 lakh prize pool.	Build an AI agent that finds company information. Plays to your n8n/agent skills.	17 Oct 2026 (Unstop).
From Prompt to Performance [BUILD]	Online, solo, starts 5 Nov	Prize not published.	Prompt-engineering challenge. Fits your CodeSignal prompt cert.	4 Nov 2026 (Unstop).
Agentic Banking Hackathon (HackerEarth) [BUILD]	Online, since 5 Oct	Prize not published.	Build an agentic banking solution. Check team size and rules on the page.	13 Nov 2026.
NASA Space Apps Challenge 2026 ⚠ [TALK/BUILD]	Weekend event, listed 14 Nov	Perks not confirmed. Global NASA-run event, good resume visibility.	Team of up to 6 solves a NASA challenge. Pick a local host (Mumbai if available).	14 Nov per Unstop. Confirm host city and date at spaceappschallenge.org.
Mumbai in-person: CognitionNext '26, Synergy 2026, D3COY ⚠	21 Oct / 1 Nov / 1 Nov	Pools: Synergy ₹12,000, D3COY ₹75,000 (CognitionNext not published).	Team up (CognitionNext 1–2, others 2–4). Themes not checked, so open each Unstop page first.	21 Oct / 27 Oct / 25 Oct.

2. Ambassador & community programs: tech / AI companies (open to India)

Name	Duration	Perks	What you do	Deadline to apply
n8n Ambassador Program (best fit) [TALK/BUILD]	Ongoing	n8n promotes your events, direct line to the n8n team, featured on their Ambassadors page.	Run n8n meetups/workshops in your city or country. They want active community members, so build forum presence first.	No deadline. Apply via the n8n Ambassador Program page.
n8n Forum: Answer & Earn [BUILD]	Monthly leaderboard	Monthly rewards (Cloud Pro plan giveaways; swag paused since mid-2026), Top Supporter badge. n8n says it hires from active members.	Answer questions in the Questions category; points for accepted solutions and likes. No AI-generated answers.	None. Resets monthly.
Mistral AI Ambassadors ⚠ [BUILD/TALK]	Ongoing, 6-month minimum	Free API credits, early access, product-feedback access, recognition, event invitations, private community.	Contribute technically or to a community (events, content). 18+. Expect a plan and examples in the form.	Rolling; cohort decisions roughly quarterly. Google Form on Mistral's page.
ElevenLabs Ambassador Program ⚠ [BUILD/SALES]	Ongoing	Product credits, early access, event support, merch, direct team support, possible paid creator work.	Needs an active ElevenLabs account plus a community or content plan. 18+.	Rolling; no fixed date. Form on ElevenLabs' page.
Cursor Ambassadors ⚠ [TALK]	Ongoing	Free credits, early access, meetup funding, merch, direct team access.	Run Cursor meetups and hackathons. 18+; applicants should already contribute to a tech community.	Reviewed weekly; reply in 2–3 weeks. Typeform on Cursor's page.
Microsoft Student Ambassadors [BUILD]	Self-paced	Microsoft 365 with Copilot, Visual Studio Enterprise, monthly Azure credits (amount not fixed), Discord/Teams community, Imagine Cup access.	Register, then complete activities (AI projects, events, content). Needs an Azure for Students account.	None. No application or interview.
SwytchCode Campus Ambassador [TALK/BUILD]	Ongoing, 5–10 hrs/week	Merch, stickers, certificate, Discord badge, free execution credits, internship/job priority.	Host AI workshops/hackathons, build a SwytchCode project, stay active in Discord.	Rolling; limited cohort. swytchcode.com/campus-ambassadors
Agora Ambassador Program [BUILD/TALK]	Ongoing, volunteer	Developer credits, sandbox access, team access, badge, swag, event materials.	Run meetups on Agora's real-time voice/AI tools; tutorials optional.	Rolling. explore.agora.io/agora-ambassador-program
Replit Campus Leaders ⚠ [TALK]	Per cohort	Replit credits, event support, community, direct team connection.	Organize events and onboard campus builders.	Program page is live; cohort timing shown on replit.com/edu/campus-leaders.
Salesforce Student Ambassador ⚠ [TALK]	Per cohort	Trailhead learning, workshops, networking, contests, prizes, merch.	Express interest, then run campus programming.	Interest page live; next cohort dates unconfirmed.
Adobe Student Ambassador ⚠ [TALK/SALES]	Per cohort	Training, community, portfolio and Adobe opportunities.	Promote Adobe tools on campus. Geography rules apply.	Page states applications are open (adobeforeducation.com).
Intel Student Ambassador ⚠ [BUILD]	Rolling / cohort	Technical community, resources, recognition.	Needs technical project experience.	Rolling or cohort-based; check Intel's portal.
Xmind Campus Leader [TALK]	One semester	1 year Xmind Premium, swag, certificate, mini-grants.	2 events per semester (1 offline).	Open now, limited cohort.
TinyFish Student Program ⚠ [BUILD]	Ongoing	$35 wallet credit, gift cards for approved builds, $5 per referral, Campus Lead budget.	Submit builds on TinyBounties (3 approved = Student Builder), then lead on campus.	Open all year. tinyfish.ai/students (vendor-published terms).

Name	Duration	Perks	What you do	Deadline to apply
IBM Z / Wolfram student ambassadors ⚠ [BUILD]	Per cohort	Training, community, recognition. Niche tech.	Use and promote the tools; mainframe or Wolfram language.	Timing varies. Verify on each program page.

3. Ambassador programs: India platforms & brands

Name	Duration	Perks	What you do	Deadline to apply
GeeksforGeeks Campus Mantri [SALES/TALK]	Ongoing, monthly targets	Stipend up to ₹20,000 (points-based), GfG Premium, goodies, mentors.	Run webinars/contests, share course codes, complete points-dashboard tasks.	Rolling. Registration live on geeksforgeeks.org.
HackerEarth Campus Ambassador [SALES/TALK]	Ongoing	Certificate of Appreciation, mentorship, recognition, prizes for driving registrations.	Fill the form, pass a short assessment, drive hackathon registrations.	Rolling. hackerearth.com/campus-ambassador-program
MyGov Campus Ambassador [TALK]	Ongoing	Certificate of Excellence, appreciation letter from the PM, passes to national-day events.	Register users, run awareness activities, file reports with proof. Strictly non-political.	Rolling. campus.mygov.in
Internshala Student Partner (ISP) [SALES]	60 days	Performance-based cash rewards (₹7 lakh pool advertised), certificate, 5+ masterclasses, marketing contests.	Run campus sessions and promote Internshala Trainings on your networks. Heavy on promotion.	Check isp.internshala.com. Open to all streams.
Unstop Campus Ambassador [SALES/TALK]	Per cycle, performance-based	Merch, certificate, referral rewards, possible internship (₹10,000 stipend) and PPI, mentorship.	Run competitions/events, drive Unstop participation, grow social presence.	Last cycle (2025-26) closed 2 Jan 2026. Next cycle not confirmed ⚠.
PW (PhysicsWallah) Campus Ambassador ⚠ [SALES]	Per cycle	Monthly stipend, free PW Skills courses, certificate, merch.	Host webinars, promote PW Skills courses.	Listed on an aggregator; verify on PW's official site before applying.
HCLTech Campus Ambassador Program ⚠ [TALK]	Year-round	Leader/alumni access, masterclasses, swag, certificates, performance rewards.	Build student conversations and share feedback. Very selective (300 chosen from 8,000+ applications, priority campuses).	Not stated. Check HCLTech's careers page.
E-Cell IIT Bombay Campus Ambassador ⚠ [TALK/SALES]	4–5 months, online	Certificate, E-Summit passes, partner courses, internship leads, big student network.	Promote E-Cell events, plan entrepreneurship events at your college. Any stream.	Not stated. Check E-Cell IIT Bombay's official site. Selection is by application answers.
Realme Campus Ambassador ⚠ [SALES]	Per cycle	Cash rewards, certificates, merch, internship leads.	Brand content and campus activations. Weak fit with your skills.	Not stated. Verify on realme's page.
Google Student Ambassador (India) ⚠ [TALK/SALES]	About 6 months	Tiered points rewards (vouchers, swag, up to Pixel devices for top tiers), certificate, mentorship.	Promote Gemini, run events, 5–7 hrs/week, active Instagram + LinkedIn. See correction note in section 7.	2025 cohort ran Jul–Dec 2025. 2026 India window not confirmed. Apply only through an official Google link.

4. Learning events & free certificates

Name	Duration	Perks	What you do	Deadline to apply
Build With AI bootcamp (Google × Reskilll) ⚠ [BUILD]	About 4 hours, in person	Free. Certificate, $5 Google Cloud credit, swag, deploy a Gemini agent on Cloud Run.	Build and deploy an AI agent with Google AI Studio. Mumbai 30–31 Oct per a secondary source; seats are shortlist-based.	No published deadline. Register at buildwithai.reskilll.com.
Global Hack Week workshops (MLH) [BUILD]	9–15 Oct	Daily livestream workshops, points, Hacktoberfest stickers.	Watch on Twitch/YouTube, join the MLH Discord.	15 Oct.
AICTE × EduSkills virtual internships (AWS, Google AI-ML, Cisco) ⚠ [BUILD]	4–10 weeks, online, cohort-based	Free. AICTE + partner certificate, digital badge, internship credits. No stipend.	Self-paced modules and a final project. Eligibility lists BE/B.Tech/Diploma/MCA at EduSkills member institutes, so check whether Somaiya and BSc IT qualify.	Cohort windows vary (AWS GenAI closed 30 Jun 2026). Check internship.aicte-india.org and eduskillsfoundation.org. Never pay a fee.

5. Internships, open-source programs & fellowships

Name	Duration	Perks	What you do	Deadline to apply
Internshala AI-agent / automation internships [BUILD]	1–6 months, mostly remote	Typical stipend ₹5,000–10,000/month (some ₹10,000–20,000 hybrid). Some offer a job after.	Build AI workflows and agents (Python, LLMs, n8n). Skip listings that need final-year students.	Per listing; apply continuously. Never pay to apply; check the company.
Unstop campus-ambassador / growth internships ⚠ [SALES]	Per listing	50+ listings posted in Sept; mostly unpaid or small stipends.	Marketing and outreach heavy. Only worth it for named brands.	Per listing.
Kharagpur Winter of Code (KWoC) ⚠ [BUILD]	About 5 weeks, from December	Certificate and mentorship; built for beginners to open source.	Contribute to open-source projects with a mentor.	Not announced. Expect registration around Nov; watch IIT Kharagpur's KOSS announcements.
Social Winter of Code (SWoC) ⚠ [BUILD]	About Jan–Mar	Certificate and recognition; beginner friendly.	Open-source contributions.	Registration historically opens around Oct–Nov. Verify on the SWoC site.
MLH Fellowship ⚠ [BUILD]	12-week remote programs	Hands-on engineering work with mentors. Stipend not confirmed.	Attend an MLH hackathon or Global Hack Week first, then apply.	Not confirmed. Check fellowship.mlh.io.
Google Summer of Code 2027 [BUILD]	8–22 weeks, summer 2027	Paid stipend, mentor, strong resume line. 18+ is enough.	Contribute to an open-source org now, then submit a proposal.	Not announced. 2026 window was 16–31 Mar.
Outreachy (May 2027 cohort) ⚠ [BUILD]	3 months	$7,000 paid remote internship.	Eligibility is decided by essays about underrepresentation in tech. Contribute to a project during the application period.	Dec 2026 cohort closed 31 Aug. May 2027 applications expected about Feb 2027.

6. Watch list: not open now, set reminders

Name	Duration	Perks	What you do	Deadline to apply
Claude Campus Ambassadors (Anthropic)	Sept–June	$3,600 stipend plus API credits.	Run a Claude Builder Club or campus events.	Closed 12 Sep 2026. Next window not announced.
OpenAI Student Collective + Codex Ambassadors	Per semester	Stipend, ChatGPT, Codex credits, event funding. India eligible for Student Collective.	Run AI workshops as a Campus Lead.	Student Collective closed 10 Aug 2026. Codex cohort active; next one planned.
AWS Student Builder Group Leader	12 months	AWS credits, Credly badges, mentorship.	Lead a student group. Needs club/event experience, a video, and 12+ months left at college.	Latest round closed 4 Oct 2026 (earlier round 10 May). Watch Builder Center.
Cursor Campus Leads	6 months	Cursor access, event funding, SF launch for the first cohort.	Lead Cursor on campus.	Fall cohort picked. Watch for the spring form.
Databricks Student Fellows ⚠	Per cohort	Certification vouchers, Free Edition access, career development.	Data/AI community work. Largely invitation-based.	Fall 2026 cohort referenced; verify.
GDG on Campus organizer (start an SBAS chapter)	1 year	Google-verified organizer title, training, campaign swag.	Needs a nearby organizer's referral, a faculty advisor and a Google-tech prototype.	Usually Mar–Jun.
Notion Campus Leaders / GitHub Campus Experts / Figma Campus Leader	Varies	Swag, training, networks.	Run campus events and workshops.	Closed 14 Jun / 31 Jul / 10 Aug 2026. Expect 2027 windows.
Hugging Face Student Ambassador / Fellows ⚠	Per cohort	Merch, workshops, recognition.	Open-source ML contributions. Fellows are nominated.	Last public ambassador call was 2022; no current intake found.

7. Skip list, and a correction

Program	Why it is out / note
Google Student Ambassador: correction to my earlier warning	I called geministudentambassador.com "not Google" too firmly. The Google Student Ambassador program is real: it ran in India (Jul–Dec 2025) and Indonesia, and Internshala's Sept 2026 guide lists it. What I could not confirm is that this specific website is Google's official portal: the domain is new, a scam checker rated it low, and it uses referral IDs. Apply only through a link published by Google or your regional program manager, and never send personal videos to a non-Google email.
Claude Corps (Anthropic)	Needs US work authorization and a year in person at a US nonprofit.
Canva Canvassadors / Microsoft Copilot Ambassadors / US paid Google program	US students only.
EDAD AI Global Campus Ambassador	Africa only; deadline passed.
Postman Student Program	Sunsetted in March 2026.

Program	Why it is out / note
IndiaAI Fellowship, IIT Mandi / IIT Madras / JNCASR summer fellowships, ERA:AI	Need pre-final or final-year status; ERA:AI excludes first-years. Revisit in year 2–3.

Source quality: hackathon dates come from live listings (Jamao, Unstop, Devfolio, HackerEarth, Hacktoberfest/MLH). Ambassador details come from official pages where I could open them, Interndock's directory (which says it checked company pages on 4 Aug 2026), Internshala's Sept 2026 guide, and TinyFish's roundup (a company promoting its own program). Rows marked ⚠ need a check on the official page before you apply.